SHPS ICT DEPARTMENT
STAFF EDITION · 2026

FOR STAFF EYES ONLY



UNLOCK WHAT'S INSIDE

The Most Coveted Hidden Guide to OneDrive Ever!

Store, sync and share safely: everything SHPS teachers and staff need to know, in plain English.

Get in
3 ways to open OneDrive

Store smart
Label, upload, save space

Share safely
Who sees what, and how to stop

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

What's hidden in this guide

Twelve short pages. Read it front to back once, then keep the cheat sheet on the last page handy.

1 **Three ways in**
Edge, the Windows OneDrive app, and Teams — Page 3

2 **Label it first**
Apply "Official-Non Sensitive" before anything else — Page 4

3 **Upload the right way**
The blue button, and why it's safer — Page 5

4 **Stop your C: drive from bloating**
The three status icons that matter — Page 6

5 **Sharing, step by step**
A tour of the Share box — Page 7

6 **Can edit, Can view, Can't download**
What each permission really allows — Page 8

7 **Send vs Copy link**
The most important difference in this guide — Page 9

8 **Stop sharing & the symbol decoder**
Manage access, plus every sharing icon explained — Page 10

9 **Oops! Rescue & common mistakes**
Recycle bin, version history, OneDrive vs Teams — Page 11

★ **Cheat sheet**
Everything on one page. Print it and pin it up. — Page 12

HOW TO READ THIS GUIDE

Words in **blue bold** are buttons or menu items you click. Pictures of screens are simplified drawings, so yours may look slightly different depending on your Windows and Microsoft 365 version.

CHAPTER 1 · GET IN

Three ways into OneDrive

01

They all open the **same** files. Pick the door that suits what you're doing.

Door A · The web portal in Microsoft Edge

Recommended

1 Open **Microsoft Edge** 2 Go to `sgmoe-my.sharepoint.com`

3 Sign in with your school account

Best for: uploading, labelling and sharing. Works on any computer, and everything in this guide is shown from here.

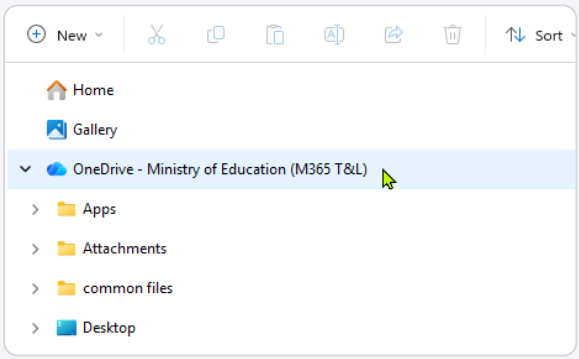
Door B · The OneDrive app on your Windows laptop

Taskbar cloud

Look for this **blue cloud** at the bottom-right of your screen. It shows sync status; click it to open your folder.

File Explorer

In the left pane, click **OneDrive - Ministry of Education (M365 T&L)**. It works like any folder, but it syncs.



Best for: opening and saving files straight from Word, Excel and PowerPoint, and working offline.

Door C · Inside the Teams app

1 Open **Teams** 2 Click **OneDrive** in the left bar 3 Choose **My files**

Best for: quickly finding a file while you're already chatting or in a meeting.

⚠ **SAME FILES, THREE WINDOWS**

Deleting a file through *any* door deletes it everywhere: on the web, in Teams, and on your laptop. Page 11 shows how to get it back.

CHAPTER 2 · STORE SMART

Step zero: label it first

02

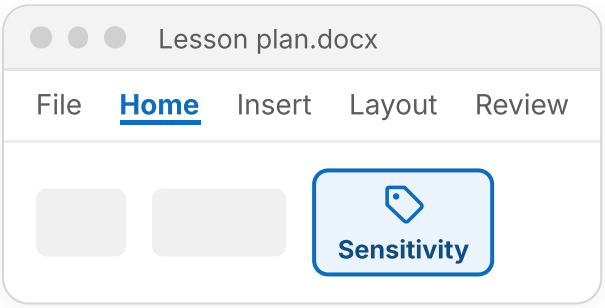
Before a file goes anywhere, give it its security classification. It takes five seconds and protects you later.

THE LABEL TO USE

Official-Non Sensitive

A For a new or open file

In Word, Excel or PowerPoint:



Click **Home** › **Sensitivity** › **Official-Non Sensitive**, then save.

B For a file already in OneDrive

On the OneDrive website:

- Select the file (tick the circle beside its name).
- Click the ⓘ **Details** icon at the top right.
- Under **Sensitivity**, choose **Official-Non Sensitive**.

ⓘ Don't see the option? The file type may not support labels (see below), or ask ICT.

⊗ These files cannot be labelled

Media
.mp4 .mov .mp3 .jpg .png

Old Office
.doc .xls .ppt (pre-2007 formats)

Text files
.txt .csv and similar

Unknown
Files with unusual or no extension

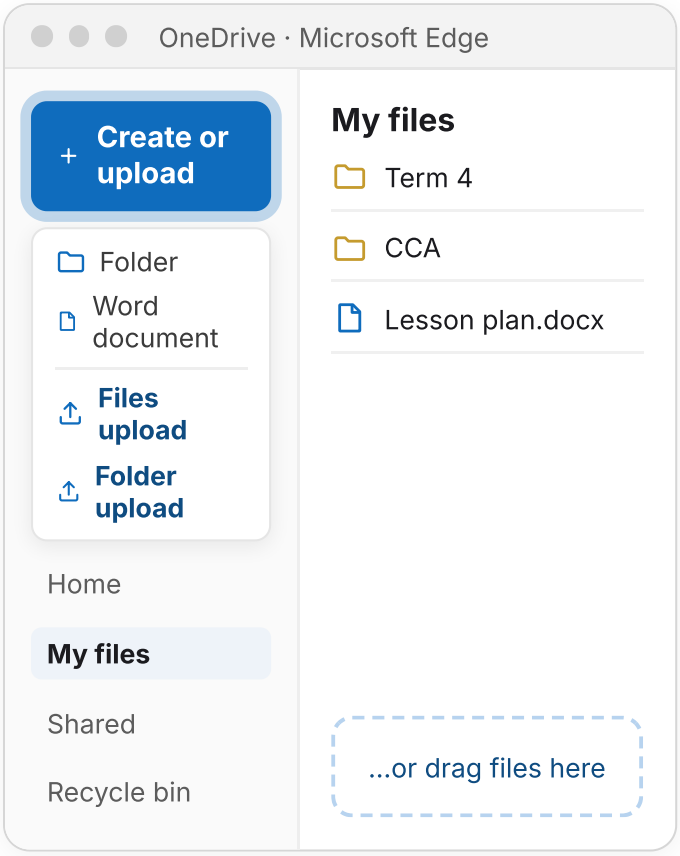
Tip: Old Office files can be labelled after you convert them. Open, then **File** › **Info** › **Convert**, which saves as .docx, .xlsx or .pptx.

CHAPTER 3 · STORE SMART

Upload the right way

03

Use the big blue button on the OneDrive website. It's the safest way to move your work into the cloud.



1. Open OneDrive in **Edge** and go to the folder you want.
2. Click the blue **+ Create or upload** button at the top of the left panel.
3. Pick **Files upload** or **Folder upload**, or create a new **Folder** or document right there.
4. Wait for the "upload complete" message, then open one file to check it's all there.

ⓘ On some versions the button reads **+ Add new**. It's the same button.

Why this is the safer way

Copy 1 · your laptop
Your original stays put

→ upload copies

Copy 2 · OneDrive cloud
Backed up and shareable

Uploading **copies** your work, so you end up with two copies. If anything goes wrong mid-upload, your original is untouched. Once you've checked the cloud copy, you can tidy up the original.

⚠ **CAREFUL WITH DRAG-AND-DROP IN FILE EXPLORER**

Dragging a file from your C: drive into the OneDrive folder **moves** it instead of copying it. If the sync then fails, there's no second copy.

CHAPTER 4 · STORE SMART

Stop your C: drive from bloating

04

The little icon in File Explorer's **Status** column tells you whether a file is eating your laptop's space.

Aim for this

Online-only

0 KB on your laptop

Lives only in the cloud. Double-click and it downloads and opens. You need internet.

Locally available

Uses space for now

White background, green tick. Downloaded because you opened it, and works offline. You can turn it back into a cloud.

Always keep on this device

Uses space permanently

Dark green background, white tick. Pinned to your laptop for good. Use it only for files you need offline for a long time.

What "bloat" looks like

Everything pinned — C: nearly full



Windows & apps · Your originals on C: · Same files again in OneDrive folder

Mostly online-only — Plenty of room



Windows & apps · Only the files you're using

Keeping everything on the laptop means **duplicate copies**: one on your hard drive and another in the OneDrive folder on C:. Keep files online-only and only today's work takes up space.

Free up space

Right-click a file or folder in your OneDrive folder › **Free up space**. It turns back into a cloud. **The file stays safe online.**

Need it offline?

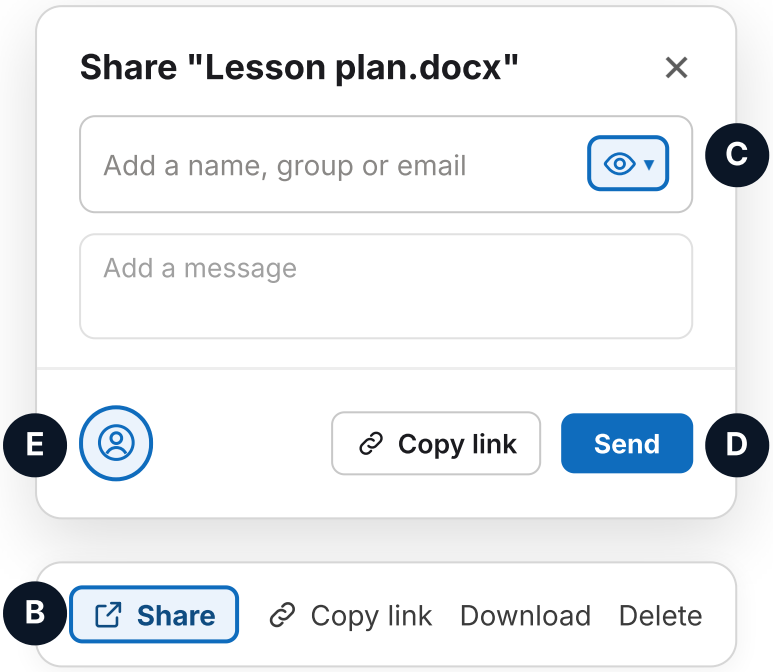
Right-click › **Always keep on this device**. Use it sparingly: for example, a scheme of work you'll use all term.

CAN'T SEE A STATUS COLUMN?

In File Explorer, right-click any column heading (Name, Date...) and tick **Status**. For every other OneDrive icon, see the ICT "OneDrive Status Icons" poster.

Sharing, step by step

Sharing with colleagues inside SHPS is safe and simple. Here's a tour of the Share box.



A **Select** the file(s) or folder by ticking the circle beside the name.

B Click **Share** in the menu along the top.

C Type your colleague's name, then click the **eye / pencil icon** on the right to choose **Can edit**, **Can view** or **Can't download**. *(Page 8 explains each.)*

D Click **Send** *or* **Copy link**. **They are not the same!** *(Page 9.)*

E Changed your mind? Click the **round head icon** at the bottom-left to open **Manage access**. *(Page 10.)*

DO

- Share with named colleagues
- Start with **Can view** and upgrade only if needed
- Double-check the name before you click Send

DON'T

- Share outside SHPS without checking with ICT
- Give a whole folder "Can edit" just to save time
- Email attachments when a share will do

CHAPTER 6 · SHARE SAFELY

Can edit · Can view · Can't download

06

The eye / pencil icon in the Share box decides what your colleague can do. Choose the smallest power that gets the job done.

Can edit

Most power

THEY CAN

- Open, change and save the file
- In a folder: add, rename and **delete** files
- Download, print and copy
- Usually re-share it with others

USE IT FOR

Co-planning a scheme of work, a shared marks file, or a committee document everyone fills in.

Can view

Safe default

THEY CAN

- Open and read it
- Download, print or copy it, and edit *their own* copy

THEY CAN'T

- Change your original

USE IT FOR

Circulars, timetables, briefing slides: anything people should read but not change.

Can't download

Tightest

THEY CAN

- View it in the web browser only

THEY CAN'T

- Download, print or copy
- Open it in the desktop or mobile app

USE IT FOR

Draft exam papers, or anything that must not leave OneDrive. **Note:** people can still take a screenshot.

⚠ When "Can't download" is greyed out or missing

- **You picked "Can edit".** It's a view-only option, so switch to Can view first.
- **The file can't be previewed in a browser**, e.g. .txt, .zip, .exe or unknown file types.
- **School settings.** IT may have turned it off, or limited it to Office files only.
- **Personal Microsoft account.** It only exists in school (work) accounts.

CHAPTER 7 · THE BIG REVEAL

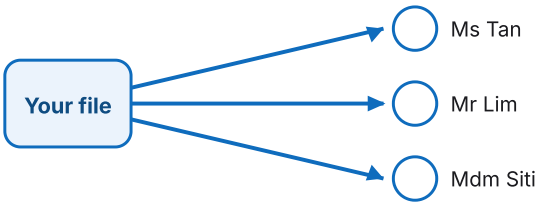
Send vs Copy link

07

Both buttons share your file, but in very different ways. If you remember only one page, make it this one.

Send

= Direct access

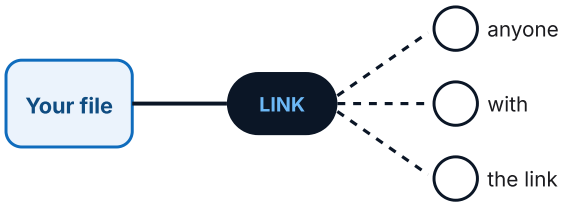


- Gives **only the people you named** permission to the file.
- They get an email, and the file appears in their **Shared** list.
- They can open and manage it **without needing the link**.
- If they forward the email, others **still can't open it**.

Best for: named colleagues

Copy link

= A key you hand out



- Creates a **link**. Nobody is told; you paste it into a chat or email.
- The file **can't be opened without the link**.
- Whoever has the link can open it, within the link's settings.
- If the link is forwarded, **new people may get in**.

Best for: posting in a Teams channel

Who can use a copied link? Check the link settings

Before copying, click the link-settings option in the Share box to see who the link works for:

People with existing access
Safest. Doesn't add anyone new.

Specific people
Only the names you add.

People in Whole of Government
Anyone across government with the link. Think twice.

Anyone
Anyone at all. Usually switched off.

RULE OF THUMB

Know their names? Use Send. Need to post it for a group? Use Copy link, with the narrowest setting that works. A link set to **Whole of Government** reaches far beyond SHPS, so prefer *Specific people* or *Existing access*.

CHAPTER 8 · SHARE SAFELY

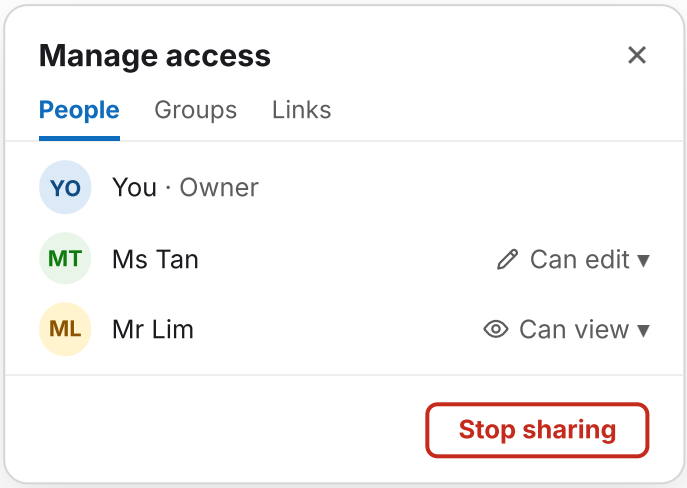
Stop sharing & the symbol decoder

08

You stay in control. Take back access at any time, and learn to read every sharing icon.

How to stop sharing

1. Select the file and click **Share**, or right-click › **Manage access**.
2. Click the **round head icon** at the bottom-left of the Share box.
3. The **Manage access** box lists everyone with **direct access**, plus every **link**.
4. Click **Stop sharing** to remove everyone at once, or change or remove one person or one link.



⚠ **Direct access vs links:** removing a person doesn't kill a link they were sent. Check the **Links** tab too, and delete links you no longer need.

The sharing symbol decoder

Share
Opens the Share box (top menu)

Copy link / chain
Makes a shareable link

Pencil · Can edit
Recipient can make changes

Send
Direct access for named people

Eye · Can view
Read-only (can still download)

Round head
Opens Manage access

Crossed download · Can't download
View in browser only

Gear · Link settings
Who a link works for, plus expiry

Key · Existing access
Link adds no new people

Person · Specific people
Link works for named people only

Building · Whole of Government
Anyone in government with the link

Globe · Anyone
Public link. Avoid it.

Two people · Shared
Others have access (Sharing column)

Padlock · Private
Only you can see it

Icons are redrawn for illustration. Microsoft's own icons may look slightly different.

CHAPTER 9 · HIDDEN POWERS

Oops! Rescue & common mistakes

09

Deleted the wrong file? Overwrote last week's version? OneDrive has your back, if you know where to look.

The Recycle bin

Deleted files wait in **Recycle bin** (left panel of the OneDrive website) for **up to 93 days**.

Select the file › **Restore**, and it goes back to where it was.

Emptied the bin? Contact ICT quickly. There's a second-stage bin, but only for a limited time.

Version history

OneDrive quietly keeps older versions every time a file is saved.

Right-click the file › **Version history** › choose a date › **Restore**.

Perfect when a colleague with "Can edit" accidentally wipes your table.

Where should this file live?

OneDrive = "My files"

Your own drafts, lesson materials and personal work. **It belongs to you.** When a staff member leaves, their OneDrive is eventually deleted.

Teams / SharePoint = "Our files"

Department and committee files that must outlive any one person. **They belong to the team.**

Rule of thumb: if a colleague taking over your role would need it, keep it in the team's Teams / SharePoint, not your OneDrive.

⚠ The five most common mistakes

1. **"I'll delete it from my laptop to save space."** Deleting from the OneDrive folder deletes it from the cloud too. Use **Free up space** instead.
2. **Emailing attachments.** This creates many out-of-date copies. Share the file instead, so everyone sees the latest version.
3. **Picking the wrong "Tan" from autocomplete.** Always check the email address before you click Send.
4. **Forgetting to label.** Apply *Official-Non Sensitive* before you upload or share.
5. **Never cleaning up shares.** Once a project ends, open **Manage access** and stop sharing.

TEAR-OFF CHEAT SHEET

OneDrive on one page

Print this page and pin it beside your desk.

GET IN

- **Edge** › sgmoe-my.sharepoint.com
- **Laptop** › blue taskbar cloud, or File Explorer › OneDrive - Ministry of Education
- **Teams** › OneDrive in the left bar

STORE

- Label **Official-Non Sensitive** first
- Use the blue **+ Create or upload** button
- Check the upload, then tidy the original

SHARE

- Select › **Share** › name › permission
- **Send** for named people
- **Copy link** to post for a group

STATUS ICONS

Online-only
No space used. Aim for this.

Locally available
Temporary copy. Free up space.

Always keep
Pinned. Long-term files only.

PERMISSIONS

Choose	Open	Change original	Download / print	Best for
Can edit	Yes	Yes	Yes	Co-writing
Can view	Yes	No	Yes	Circulars, timetables
Can't download	Browser only	No	No	Drafts that must stay put

TAKE IT BACK

Share box › round head icon › **Manage access** › **Stop sharing**. Check the Links tab too.

OOPS

Recycle bin: up to 93 days. Right-click › **Version history**: restore an older copy.

Still stuck? Ask ICT Department.
The venerable DEs and ICT Team

GUIDE UNLOCKED

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BONUS · KEEP LEARNING

Learn more, straight from Microsoft

Want to see it in action? These official Microsoft pages pick up where this guide leaves off. Scan the code with your phone, or click the link.

OneDrive video tutorials

Watch

Short videos that show each step on screen. Great if you'd rather watch than read.

MOST USEFUL FOR SHPS STAFF

- **OneDrive for web**: open, manage and share files in Edge
- **OneDrive for Windows**: sync and back up your laptop
- **Share and collaborate**: work on a file with colleagues
- **Mobile for work and school**: your files on your phone

support.microsoft.com/en-us/onedrive/training/onedrive-video-tutorials

Scan to watch

OneDrive help & learning

Look it up

Microsoft's full help centre for OneDrive. Search it when you have a question this guide doesn't answer.

WHAT YOU'LL FIND

- **Basics**: getting started, setting up on phones and tablets
- **Back up and share**: sharing, saving disk space, folder backup
- **Manage**: storage limits, photos, sync settings
- **Troubleshooting**: fixes for sync errors and other problems

support.microsoft.com/en-us/onedrive

Scan for help

SCHOOL RULES STILL APPLY

Microsoft's videos are made for everyone, so some screens and options may differ from our school account. Whatever they show, still **label files Official-Non Sensitive** and follow the sharing advice in this guide.

TIP

Turn on **captions** in the video player if you're watching in the staff room, and use the **search box** at the top of the help page to jump straight to your topic.

Use with thanks from St Hilda's Primary School ICT Department